Not Human Subjects Research (NHSR) Self-Certification Tool

This tool is designed to help researchers determine if their project falls outside the Institutional Review Board (IRB)'s scope according to the federal definition of human subjects research (45 CFR 46). It assists in identifying projects that do not require IRB review because they do not constitute human subjects research or are considered non-regulated research.

Disclaimers: This tool cannot be used for exempt determinations. "Exempt" means that a study meets the definition of human subjects research but is exempted from certain federal requirements. At UT Austin, exempt determinations must be made by the IRB and some institutional review criteria still apply, so these should be submitted through UTRMS-IRB.

This tool does not determine all cases when a project falls outside the IRB's purview. It is intended only to help assess whether a project is regulated by the IRB.
This form is not monitored by the IRB staff. For any questions, please email irb@austin.utexas.edu and/or see https://research.utexas.edu/resources/human-subjects/researcher-support.

Instructions: Complete the form by including requested information about your project. Select the appropriate answers to each question in the order they appear below. Additional questions may appear based on your responses.

At the end of this form, you will have the option to save a .pdf of your responses for your records. This may be used for documentation that IRB review is not required.

If you require an official Not Human Subjects Research (NHSR) determination letter from the IRB, save a .pdf of your responses, create a new study in UTRMS-IRB, and upload the .pdf of your responses from this tool as your protocol form in the online application. Only upload the responses from this tool if the determination was not human subjects research. Attach the responses in the "IRB proposal" section on the Basic Study Information page of the UTRMS application.

NHSR Certification Tool

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Submitter's Name *

Debashis Patra

2

Primary Investigator's Name (if different from submitter)

Enter your answer

3

Primary Investigator's Department *

Department of Computer Science, The University of Texas at Austin

4

Date of Completion *

Select the date this form is being completed.

10/4/2026

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Project Title *

Governance-Aware Human-in-the-Loop AI for Structuring Longitudinal Autism Interve

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Which sites will this project involve?
Select all that apply. *

Note: Activities taking place in Ascension facilities or using Ascension patient data may require Site Approval Tool (SAT) submission and review. Contact Ascension Research Administration (siteapproval@seton.org) for more information.
Transfer of data, including de-identified data, may require a Data Use Agreement (DUA). Contact OSP for additional guidance (osp@austin.utexas.edu).

- [x] UT Austin
- [ ] UT Health Austin
- [ ] Dell Medical School
- [ ] Ascension (includes Dell Children's Medical Center, Dell Seton Medical Center at UT Austin, etc.)
- [ ] Central Health
- [ ] CommUnity Care
- [ ] Other

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Project Summary *

Provide a brief summary of the project. In this summary, please describe:

- The purpose, design, and activities of the project.
- Any data that will be obtained/collected.
- UT's specific involvement in the project (i.e., if this is a multi-site project, what activities will be conducted by UT employees/agents).

If UT is involved in a multi-site human subjects research project and you have questions about whether UT IRB review is needed, please STOP completing this form and instead reach out to IRBReliance@austin.utexas.edu for guidance.

NOTE: This text box has a 4,000 character limit, including spaces. If you are copy/pasting from another document, please confirm all relevant information to address the question appears in the text box.

This project is an independently conducted software-development and component-evaluation study examining a governance-aware, human-in-the-loop artificial intelligence workflow for organizing longitudinal autism intervention evidence. The system is intended to support evidence organization and professional review and is not designed to diagnose autism, recommend treatment, determine eligibility for services, or make autonomous intervention decisions.

The empirical evaluation uses existing archival autism-language data from the ASDBank English Rollins and Flusberg corpora within TalkBank, accessed under the applicable TalkBank/ASDBank terms. The archival transcripts are used as proxy data for evaluating structured information extraction and related governance mechanisms. No children or other individuals represented in the archival corpus were recruited, contacted, or interacted with by the research team, and no new information was collected from them.

To establish a reference standard for evaluating the AI extraction outputs, two experienced autism-domain specialists independently reviewed and annotated selected de-identified transcript segments using a study-defined annotation codebook. After the independent annotation rounds, remaining disagreements were resolved through a joint consensus-adjudication session. Dr. Som S. Mukherjee facilitated contact with the specialists and the consensus session but did not make the annotation decisions. The specialists' identities are kept confidential. Their participation was limited to professional interpretation and annotation of the de-identified research material; they did not provide diagnosis, treatment recommendations, or child-outcome assessments.

The study evaluates annotation reliability, agreement between AI-generated structured fields and the expert reference standard, unsupported assertions, missing outputs, multi-model reranking, evidence adequacy/abstention, and

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Will the project involve testing an experimental drug, device (including medical software or mobile app), or biologic? *

If any of the following are true, the answer is Yes:

- The project involves use of a drug, device, or biologic in one or more persons outside of medical practice. This means the drug/device/biologic is specified by the research and/or is not being provided by a practitioner to treat an individual patient based on the patient's own best interest.
- The project evaluates the safety and/or effectiveness of a drug, device, or biologic, either FDA-approved or non-approved.
- The project compares one or more drugs, devices, or biologics.
- Data from the project will be submitted to or held for inspection by the FDA, such as for purposes of research or marketing. This applies even if the project does not involve living individuals or identifiable biospecimens.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

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Has the project received funding (e.g., federal, industry) to be conducted **as a human subjects research study?** *

Has UT Austin or DMS received a direct award - grant, contract, or cooperative agreement - to conduct human subjects research (e.g., NIH, DHHS)?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

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Is this a research project: a systematic investigation designed to contribute to generalizable knowledge? *

Systematic Investigation is a planned activity involving qualitative or quantitative data collection and data analysis that sets forth an objective(s) and a set of procedures intended to reach the objective(s), i.e., to acquire knowledge, develop a theory, or answer a question.

Generalizable Knowledge means information from which one may infer a general conclusion; knowledge brought into general use or that can be applied to a wider or different range of circumstances.

If the project involves any of the following, it may be considered generalizable:

- Testing a hypothesis
- Randomization of subjects
- Comparison of experimental vs. control
- Observational research
- Comparative effectiveness research

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

Involvement of Human Subjects

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Does the research involve human subjects? *

Will the information or biospecimens involved in the research be from or about **living** individuals?

- This question applies regardless of identifiability or how samples are obtained.
- If the information or biospecimens are from individuals now deceased, FDA and HIPAA regulations still apply.

Contact the IRB Office for further guidance, irb@austin.utexas.edu.

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

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Will the investigator obtain, use, study, analyze, or generate the information or biospecimens through **intervention** or **interaction** with the individuals? *

Intervention includes:

- Physical procedures or manipulations of the individuals, and/or
- Manipulation of their environment for research purposes.

Interaction includes:

- Communication with the individuals (including remote/online communications, such as surveys), and/or
- Interpersonal contact with the individuals.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

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Will the investigator obtain, use, study, analyze, or generate **identifiable private** information or **identifiable** biospecimens? *

Private information describes:

- Information about behavior that occurs in a context in which an individual can reasonably expect that no observation or recording is taking place, and/or
- Information that has been provided for a specific purpose(s) in which an individual can reasonably expect that it will not be made public (e.g., a medical record).

Individually identifiable describes:

- Information or biospecimens for which the identity of the participant is, or may be, ascertained, and/or
- Information or biospecimens that may be associated with or linked to the individual by the investigator.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

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Will the investigator obtain newborn screening blood spots for research purposes (regardless of identifiability)? *

HHS supported research using dried blood spots from newborn screening is considered human subjects research per federal law and requires IRB review and approval.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

Type of Data

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Does the research involve secondary use of only anonymous data or biospecimens? *

- Anonymous materials are those with no personally identifiable information contained in the original data or attached to the specimen.
- None of the 18 HIPAA identifiers, such as dates of treatment, are included.
- "Secondary use" refers to research using existing data or specimens that were (or will be) collected for a different primary purpose, rather than collecting new data specifically for the proposed study.

If the data or specimen has a unique code traceable to a key with identifying information, this is not anonymous.